

SCIENCE IS THE PATH TO KNOWLEDGE, AND FINDING OUT ABOUT HOW OUR UNIVERSE WORKS. YOU CAN'T BE A GEEK AND NOT KNOW YOUR SCIENCE!

IN SCIENCE

THIS MONTH:

Largest storms in history, social media profiling, genome analysis in healthcare, exploring our ignorance about addiction, and taking a look at animal species that have been to space



Solar system has a twin

Using the data obtained from the Kepler space telescope, NASA has discovered the eighth planet in the Kepler-90 system, tying it with our very own for the most number of planets. Interestingly, machine learning technology was used to identify the planet.' <http://dgit.in/SolrTwin>

WHAT'S NEW

Trump administration reportedly bans list of words for CDC

The government in USA has banned the Centre for Disease Control from using certain words in its official documents. The words are "vulnerable," "entitlement," "diversity," "transgender," "fetus," "evidence-based" and "science-based." And in case you were wondering, the CDC cannot get away with using alternative terminology like 'based on scientific studies'. It has instead been instructed to base its recommendations "in consideration with community standards and wishes".

This could effectively mean that the CDC would have to take an official stance of acceptance towards ideas like homeopathy and beliefs like 'vaccines cause autism'. While the Department of Health and Human Services has tried to play down the reports by suggesting that the instructions were to use alternative words to ease the passing of the CDC budget, public health advocates have expressed outrage over how effective work against diseases can be done when it cannot include essential terms like "science-based".

<http://dgit.in/CDCBan>

BANNED

China bets big on railguns and catapults

While the US Navy has reduced its efforts to develop electromagnetic railguns and catapults, China has been making quite a few under-the-radar advancements in the same area. In addition to being the leading nation when it comes to unclassified, peer-reviewed electromagnetic launch research in the world, there are other things that indicate



China's increasing interest in the same. For instance, in a presentation at PLAN Univer-

sity, Wuhan (which is home to their land-based testing rig for aircraft carriers) Rear Admiral Ma Weiming told Chinese EM research experts that the country has made breakthroughs in key areas of electromagnetic applications, such as railguns and electromagnetic-assisted launch system (EMALS) catapults. Exciting times ahead! <http://dgit.in/ChinaRGun>



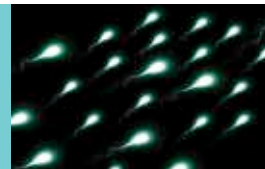
Most dilute liquid in the universe

In Barcelona, a team of physicists at the Institute of Photonic Sciences has created a liquid that is 100 times thinner than water, but is still able to hold itself together thanks to quantum physics. This was achieved by pushing two potassium-based Bose-Einstein condensates together. <http://dgit.in/QntmDrops>



Mysterious Uttarakhand dinosaur corpse

An electrician in Uttarakhand, India, stumbled upon a dinosaur-like corpse while cleaning a sub-station. While scientists are struggling to understand the discovery, the body itself has been sent for further analysis to Kumaun University <http://dgit.in/DinolIndia>



Sperm can cure cancer

Researchers at the Leibniz Institute for Solid State and Materials Research in Germany have discovered that sperm cells loaded with doxorubicin, a common agent used in chemotherapy, are effective in targeting tumor cells in the female reproductive tract. <http://dgit.in/SpermVsCancer>